Resilience Academy

SDI Training for ICT Professionals

KoboToolbox Installation

Setting Up Your Own Data Collection Server

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Day 3 | 30 Minutes Intro Lecture | crd.resilienceacademy.ac.tz

Resilience Academy

What Will Happen During Installation

Three Simple Steps (the instructor will guide you through each one)

The installation uses Docker, the same container technology you learned about on Day 1. KoboToolbox provides an **automated setup wizard** that asks you simple questions and does the hard work for you.

Step 1
Clone the KoboToolbox files

→

Step 2
Run the setup wizard

→

Step 3
Start the services

What "clone" means:
Download the KoboToolbox project files from GitHub. You type one command and the files are copied to your server.

What "setup wizard" means:
A script that asks you questions (like your server name) and creates the correct settings automatically.

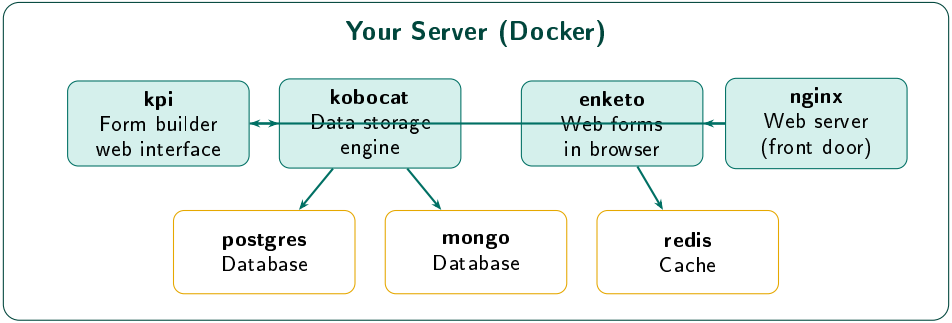
The Setup Wizard: What It Asks You

The wizard asks simple questions. Here are the answers for our training:

Question the wizard asks	What you type
Installation type?	1 (for local/training)
Server hostname?	`localhost`
Use HTTPS (secure connection)?	no (training only)
Super admin username?	`admin`
Super admin password?	`your-chosen-password`
Use default ports?	`yes`

Important Notes

What Containers Will Run



You interact with:

- **kpi** – where you design forms and view data

Running in the background:

- **nginx** – directs web traffic to the right place

How to Verify: Is KoboToolbox Running?

After the setup finishes, check these things:

Check 1: Open the login page

- Open your web browser
- Go to `http://localhost` (or your server address)
- You should see the **KoboToolbox login page** with a username/password form

Check 2: Log in with the admin account

- Enter the admin username and password you chose during setup
- You should see the **KoboToolbox dashboard** – an empty project list

Check 3: Verify all containers are running

- In the terminal, run: `docker compose ps`
- You should see all containers listed with status **"Up"** (green/healthy)
- If any show "Exit" or "Restarting", tell the instructor

Common Issues and How to Fix Them

What You See	Likely Cause	How to Fix
"Page cannot be reached" in browser	Services still starting up	Wait 2–3 minutes and refresh the page
Login page appears but login fails	Wrong password entered during setup	Re-run the setup wizard
`docker compose ps` shows containers "Restarting"	Port already in use by another service	Stop the other service or change the port
"Permission denied" errors in terminal	Need administrator privileges	Add `sudo` before the command
Very slow first load	Docker downloading container images	Be patient – first start takes 5–10 minutes

Ready for the Practical

What You Now Know

- Installation has **3 steps**: clone, wizard, start
- The wizard asks simple questions – you type short answers
- KoboToolbox runs as **7 Docker containers** working together
- You verify by opening the **login page** in a browser
- Most problems are solved by **waiting** for startup to complete

In the Practical Session

The instructor will guide you through each step:

1. Open the terminal on your training VM
2. Clone the KoboToolbox repository
3. Run the setup wizard together
4. Start the services
5. Verify the login page works
6. Log in with your admin account